

CHRISTOPHER TORRES

Head of Product Experience | UX Design Director | Fractional UX, Design & Product Leadership

Available for Remote Contracts & Fractional Engagements — US & Canada

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SUMMARY

Senior UX design and product leader with 15+ years building and managing UX organizations across enterprise and growth-stage companies. Founder of Marketeq Digital, where I've personally recruited, trained, and managed 60+ designers across UX, UI, service design, and visual design over four years, embedded within a 240-person cross-functional product organization spanning 30+ functional disciplines. Former Chief Product Officer at Referrizer, where I hired and managed an additional ~20 designers across the product team. Senior UX architect on the City National Bank enterprise platform engagement via LTI. AI-native operator with hands-on shipping fluency. Available for remote contract and fractional UX, design, and product leadership and management engagements.

CAPABILITIES

UX Design Organization Leadership — Hiring, performance management, mentorship, and career development for UX design teams of 5–50+. 80+ designers personally trained and managed across career. Stakeholder and executive communication. Budget and resource planning. Vendor and contractor management.

Product Team & Squad Management — Managing cross-functional product squads and scrum teams across design, engineering, QA, PM, and product ops. Sprint planning, daily standups, retrospectives, scrum-of-scrums coordination across multiple parallel squads.

QA Team Management — Managing QA teams and QA processes, including QA hiring, QA SOPs and runbooks, automated and manual testing workflow design, regression testing strategy, and integration with design and engineering handoff cycles.

Design Operations — Design system development and governance, design review and quality standards, design-to-engineering handoff workflows, cross-functional partnership with product and engineering.

Product Leadership — Product roadmaps, backlog management, MVP definition and scoping, feature prioritization, product strategy, OKRs, cross-functional leadership across design, engineering, PM, and QA.

Product & Growth Strategy — Product-led growth strategy, growth strategy infrastructure, conversion optimization, customer lifecycle and retention strategy, B2B SaaS and marketplace platform strategy.

Service Design — End-to-end service blueprints, front-stage and back-stage process mapping, business model design, service ecosystem strategy.

AI Automation & AI-Native Execution — AI agent automation design, AI-assisted product workflows, hands-on architecture and shipping of MVP software using modern AI development tooling.

Accessibility — WCAG-compliant design practices, accessible design system standards, inclusive design principles.

Mentorship & Training — SOPs, training programs, design and product hiring pipelines, onboarding systems, design QA frameworks. Personally mentored 60+ designers; 44 public LinkedIn recommendations.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & CEO — Marketeq Digital *Nov 2014 – Present*
Remote

Built and led a virtual cross-functional product organization of 240+ team members across 30+ functional disciplines, including engineering, AI/ML, data science, QA, DevOps, service design, and product operations. Personally serve as design manager, design strategy lead, and design quality reviewer for 60+ trained designers.

- Recruited, onboarded, and managed 60+ designers across UX, UI, service design, and visual design through structured talent intake pipelines, embedded within a broader 240-person product organization.
- Authored 20+ design and product SOPs, design system standards, and training programs that enabled junior designers to consistently produce senior-quality output.
- Led daily design standups, sprint planning, design reviews, and cross-functional design partnerships across product, engineering, and operations teams.
- Built design operations infrastructure including intake systems, design system documentation, QA processes, and design-to-engineering handoff workflows.
- Established and maintained design quality standards across enterprise marketplace platform projects including talent profiles, search, authentication, onboarding, and marketplace flows.
- Personally architected and built the MVP for Marketeq's global talent marketplace platform using AI-assisted development tooling, then codified the entire build process into prompt libraries and runbooks for the team to continue execution.
- 44 designers I personally trained have publicly recommended my leadership on LinkedIn; alumni now design at companies including TELUS Digital, AOL, Accolade, Cisco, IBM, Pratt Institute, and others.

Chief Product Officer — Referrizer Jul 2021 – Nov 2023

Remote

Led product strategy and the product team for a B2B local-business marketing automation platform. Reported directly to CEO. Owned product roadmap, product team hiring, and product-led growth strategy across all customer touchpoints.

- Recruited, managed, and grew the product team executing the company's vision of becoming the leading local-business marketing automation platform.
- Hired and managed ~20 designers across the product team, building and scaling the design function.
- Owned product roadmap, backlog management, sprint cadence, and feature prioritization across the product surface.
- Owned design strategy and design quality across dashboards, marketing site, brand identity, and customer-facing product surfaces.
- Led product strategy initiatives to increase sales, improve client retention, and create new growth channels.
- Optimized user experience across every customer touchpoint to maximize value and revenue.

Senior UX Solutions Architect — LTI / Larsen & Toubro Infotech Jul 2019 – Oct 2019

New York, NY · Contract

Senior UX architect on the City National Bank enterprise platform engagement.

- Defined enterprise platform UX for City National Bank's internal users globally.
- Led UX research, process mapping, and complex enterprise design in a heavily matrixed organization.
- Drove projects to launch using Agile/Scrum methodology.
- Facilitated brainstorming sessions, focus groups, and requirements-gathering with clients, internal staff, and management.

Founder & Senior UX Lead — Uptu May 2020 – Apr 2021

San Francisco Bay Area

Led a team of UX designers and business analysts to design and develop the MVP for a competitive social media platform including mobile app, web app, advertising platform, landing pages, and business website. Owned research strategy, design sprint backlog, and strategic design direction.

Senior UX Designer — Photon *Mar 2020 – May 2020*

San Diego, CA · Remote Contract

Scoped and led UX design for a prescription drug pricing platform. Defined information architecture, design patterns, task flows, wireframes, mockups, and design specifications across cross-functional stakeholders including clients, program managers, researchers, and developers.

Senior Product Advisor — CornerstoneAI *Jun 2021 – Dec 2021*

Advisory role supporting product strategy and design direction for an AI-focused workforce intelligence platform.

Earlier Experience *2007 – 2019*

Senior UX architect, design lead, and product strategy roles across enterprise and startup engagements including Auto Auction Advisors, Interval International (Information Architect), Wyncode Academy (UX/UI cohort instructor), Startup Launch Program (founder and instructor, 200+ recorded UX strategy training videos), Blend Metrics (Senior UX Architect), Ninseb Enterprises (Managing Partner; pitch deck received \$25M+ in investment offers), and Mass Nutrition (Digital Marketing Director, e-commerce growth and SEO).

TOOLS

Design — Figma (advanced: components, variants, auto-layout, design systems, prototyping, design tokens, dev mode), Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite, Adobe XD, InVision.

Product Management — ProductBoard, Jira, Linear, Asana, Trello, Confluence.

Collaboration & Documentation — Miro, FigJam, Notion, Loom, Slack.

AI-Assisted Workflows — Claude, Claude CLI, Codex, MCP servers, prompt engineering.